Mandarin Chinese
102
Ricks College

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> People sometimes ask me about what can be done to "open China." In response, I state my belief that China is already "open"—it is we who are closed. We are closed because we expect the Orient to be the same as the West, China to be the same as Canada or Chile. We must understand their way of thinking, their aspirations and their impressive accomplishments. We must observe their laws, and follow their example of patience. We must deserve to be their friends.
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> As we become friends of China, and as we learn from them, our Father in Heaven, who has made "all nations of men . . . and [has] determined . . . the bounds of their habitation" (Acts 17:26), will bring His purposes to pass in that great nation "in his own time, and in his own way, and according to his own will" (D &C 88:68). (Dallin H. Oaks, from a devotional address given at BYU on March 12, 1991 entitled "Getting to Know China," as cited in *From the East: The History of the Latter-day Saints in Asia • 1851–1996* by R. Lanier Britsch (Salt Lake City: Deseret Book Company, 1998), p. 306.)

I. INTRODUCTION

Congratulations on your decision to continue exploring one of the most interesting languages in the world. Successful completion of Chinese 101 or an equivalent college-level Chinese course is prerequisite to taking this class. For other experience with the language, which may fulfill the prerequisite, please see the instructor.

II. COURSE OBJECTIVES

Students will gain listening, speaking, reading and writing skills in standard (Mandarin) Chinese. Specifically, students should be able to achieve the following (based on ACTFL proficiency guidelines):

Listening: Able to understand sentence-length utterances which consist of recombinations of learned elements in a limited number of content areas, particularly if strongly supported by the situational context. Comprehension areas include such basic needs as getting meals, lodging, and transportation, and receiving simple instructions and routine commands.

Speaking: Able to handle successfully a limited number of uncomplicated task-oriented and social functions pertaining to such topic areas as those mentioned above. Can ask and answer questions, initiate and respond to simple statements and maintain face-to-face conversation. Can perform such tasks as introducing self, ordering a meal, asking directions, and making purchases.

Reading: Can read, for basic survival and social needs, simple connected, specially prepared material and can puzzle out pieces of some authentic material as it reflects similarity to specially prepared material and / or to high-frequency oral vocabulary and structure. Can puzzle out very simple hand-printed messages, personal notes and very short letters which are written by a native speaker used to dealing with foreigners. Able to decode one or two elements from simple connected texts dealing with basic personal and social needs, such as signs, public announcements and short, straightforward instructions dealing with public life.

Writing: Able to meet limited practical writing needs. Can write short messages, postcards, and take down simple notes, such as telephone messages. Can create statements or questions within the scope of limited language experience. Material produced consists of recombinations of learned vocabulary and structures into simple sentences on very familiar topics.

III. COURSE MATERIALS

1. Tao-chung Yao and Yuehua Liu, *Integrated Chinese, Level One, Part 2, Textbook* (Traditional Character Edition), Boston: Cheng & Tsui, 1997.

2. Tao-chung Yao and Yuehua Liu, *Integrated Chinese, Level One, Part 2, Workbook* (Traditional Character Edition), Boston: Cheng & Tsui, 1997.

3. McNaughton, William and Li Ying. *Reading and Writing Chinese*, Revised ed. Rutland, Vermont: Charles E. Tuttle Company, 1999.

4. Galer, Scott. *Chinese 102 Supplement*, Rexburg, Idaho: Ricks College Press, 2000. Available at the bookstore (check the "late arrivals" shelves).

5. Tapes corresponding to the Textbook and Workbook are also available at the bookstore. There are limited copies of these tapes available in the library if you do not wish to purchase your own copies.

IV. CLASS REQUIREMENTS

1. *Attendance*: Attendance is mandatory. Absences should be excused in advance. **More than three absences will lower your grade by a letter. Five tardies will achieve the same results**. As an incentive to attend class and be on time, I will add two percentage points to your final grade if you have no absences (excused or unexcused) or tardies during the entire semester.

2. *Class preparation*: Always come to class prepared for the day's lesson. This includes listening to the applicable tapes. Please come to class prepared to participate. If you consistently prepare and actively participate, you will find Chinese not only easy, but fun! Lack of preparation will cause you to become lost and frustrated.

3. *Homework and Assignments*: **Late homework and assignments will NOT be accepted**. Homework that is completed and turned in on time will receive at least 7 points. If the homework is completed without error, 10 points will be awarded. Those receiving 7 points may correct their homework, clearly indicating why they have made changes, and resubmit it **at the beginning of the next class period** for 10 points.

4. *Quizzes and tests*: Quizzes and tests cannot be made up unless arrangements are made BEFORE being absent from class. **No one is allowed to make up a missed test without first notifying the instructor of the absence.**

V. GRADING

1. Daily preparation and participation: 25%

Each day you will award yourself, and be awarded by the instructor, between 0 and 4 points. The following scale indicates the criteria for these points:

4 points:	performance is such that it would cause no communication problems for a native speaker of Mandarin Chinese. In other words they would understand what you say.
3.5	performance would cause no communication problems, but there are one or more noticeable errors in pronunciation or grammar
3	communication is achieved but with at least one major error and minor errors in pronunciation, grammar
2.5	communication is achieved but with at least temporary breakdown needing the

instructor's help

2.0 needs intervention more than once to finish the performance

1.0 no communication took place, but showed some awareness of the material

0 showed no awareness of the material or was absent

2. Quizzes: 25%
3. Homework and Assignments (including dialogue presentations): 25%
4. Midterm and final: 25%

Scale:	93–100%	A
	90–92%	A-
	87–89%	B+
	83–86%	B
	80–82%	B-
	77–79%	C+
	73–76%	C
	70–72%	C-
	67–69%	D+
	63–66%	D
	60–62%	D-
	0–59%	F

VI. GENERAL

1. If you are in need of assistance, see the instructor for help. Please make an appointment and try to identify your specific problem before you come. Remember, extra help is not a substitute for not studying and doing homework. It is your responsibility to keep up and ask for help when required or desired.

2. The instructor will make every reasonable effort to accommodate students with special handicaps. Please inform him of any special needs during the first week of class.

3. In response to health, death and other unforeseen circumstances, the instructor reserves the right to make changes to the syllabus during the course of the semester.

VII. HELPFUL HINTS

1. Repetition and continued review are the keys to learning a language. Everything you learn will be cumulative. Do not attempt to cram before a quiz or test. Doing so may have unpleasant results. Language is also best studied in frequent short periods of time rather than long, stale blocks of time. Try spending a half hour two to four times daily rather than two hours all in one lump studying.

2. Make every class a learning experience. Don't be afraid to speak up in class or make mistakes! The way you learn to communicate is by trying to say something, even if you don't know exactly how. Please remember that each student's background, interests, learning style, difficulties and goals are different. Please be patient with each other.

3. You must practice. Language is a set of habits, and the only way to acquire these habits is by constant reinforcement through practice and repetition—both in class and at home.

4. Study often out loud. Reading aloud and repeating dialogues aloud helps to learn new material by adding auditory and motor memory.